

STARVIVORS ENEMY AND ASTEROID PROTOTYPE CHECKLIST

Purpose: Track the work needed to make live enemies and asteroid hazards match the readability and communication quality of the prototype preview files.

Roster source: src/data/enemyDefinitions.ts, ENEMY_DEFINITIONS, 26 live entries.

Editable source:
Docs/STARVIVORS_ENEMY_AND_ASTEROID_PROTOTYPE_CHECKLIST.html

Generated: 2026-05-29

Prototype references are the files under Docs/references/Enemy_Prototype/Preview Files/ named preview-enemy-*.html. Use them as player-facing clarity references, not as a mandate to copy colors or exact shapes. Current validation mode: Scout-only spawning is active for enemy polish phase 1. Asteroid spawning, activation, breakup, and collision validation remain unchanged.

GOAL AND SUCCESS CRITERIA

Each live enemy should read as a distinct combat role before it damages the player. The player should be able to understand what the enemy is about to do, where the danger will occur, when the action is unsafe, and when the enemy has recovered or died. Asteroids should remain simple world hazards with varied asteroid-like shapes and clear collision feedback.

- ☐ Every live enemy has a role-specific silhouette at gameplay scale.
- ☐ Attack VFX show origin, path or area, impact, and recovery state.
- ☐ Hit, death, split, summon, shield, repair, and status feedback are distinct.
- ☐ Every dangerous enemy action has a visible telegraph before the damage window.
- ☐ Audio cues reinforce high-risk telegraphs without masking player feedback.
- ☐ Live gameplay validation passes in dense fights, not only in isolated previews.

PROTOTYPE VISUAL RULES

RULE	ACCEPTANCE NOTES	DONE
Readable state changes	Windup, active, recovery, shielded, damaged, enraged, summoning, repairing, and fleeing states are visible without reading debug text.	☐
Clear telegraphs	Lines, arcs, rings, pulses, cones, and countdowns use consistent timing and enough contrast against the world.	☐
Attack trails	Projectiles, beams, dashes, shockwaves, mines, and area attacks leave short-lived path information the player can parse.	☐
Recovery feedback	After a high-risk attack, the enemy shows a readable cooldown or vulnerability beat before returning to pressure.	☐
Role-specific silhouettes	Fast, heavy, ranged, support, spawn, status, stealth, and loot enemies are identifiable by shape at HUD/gameplay scale.	☐
Live-game validation	Readability is checked in real runs with HUD, pickups, shots, asteroids, squads, and accessibility settings active.	☐

ENEMY CHECKLIST

Work tracker columns: Sil = silhouette, Mov = movement read, Tel = telegraph, Atk = attack VFX, Aud = audio cue, Hit = death/hit feedback, Val = live validation.

PURSUIT, COLLISION, AND BURST THREATS												
	ENEMY	ROLE	PROTOTYPE REF	DESIGN BRIEF	SIL	MOV	TEL	ATK	AUD	HIT	VAL	
☐	Scout ACTIVE PHASE TARGET	chaser	Live baseline chaser	Fast basic pressure unit; direction, intent, contact danger, and death pop must stay readable in groups. Current validation mode forces enemy spawn paths to Scout only while asteroids remain unchanged.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
☐	Shard Drone	chaser	splitter child	Small fragment pursuer spawned from Splitter; must read as lower-threat debris-like enemy, not as collectible scrap.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
☐	Wedge Striker	charger	charger	Windup line, committed dash lane, impact trail, and recovery pause should make the dash fair at speed.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
☐	Hex Tank	tank	tank	Large durable pursuer; heavy mass, slow turn, strong collision threat, and high-value destruction should be obvious.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
☐	Reactor Drone	exploder	exploder	Countdown radius and escalating core state must tell the player exactly when and where the blast will hit.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
☐	Impact Bomber	exploder	exploder	Contact-trigger bomber; proximity danger, short fuse behavior, blast radius, and impact should read faster than Reactor Drone.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
☐	Berserker	berserker	berserker	Damage thresholds must visibly shift speed and aggression so the player notices each enraged phase.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

RANGED AND STATUS PRESSURE												
	ENEMY	ROLE	PROTOTYPE REF	DESIGN BRIEF	SIL	MOV	TEL	ATK	AUD	HIT	VAL	
☐	Diamond Gunner	ranged	shooter	Orbit shooter; muzzle flash, bolt path, range preference, and retreat behavior should be visible in squad clutter.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
☐	Needle Sniper	sniper	sniper	Long aim beam, lock beat, rail shot path, and cooldown must read as high danger before damage lands.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
☐	Frost Gunner	freezer	poisoner/freezer	Status shooter; cold projectile, slowed-player feedback, and status expiration need a distinct frost read.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
☐	Electric Leech	electric	poisoner/freezer	Status shooter; arc bolt, damage ticks, acceleration drag, and leech pressure must not be confused with frost.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

ENEMY CHECKLIST CONTINUED

SPAWN, SWARM, AND SPLIT CONTROL												
	ENEMY	ROLE	PROTOTYPE REF	DESIGN BRIEF	SIL	MOV	TEL	ATK	AUD	HIT	VAL	
☐	Splitter	splitter	splitter	Parent death should clearly fracture into Shard Drones with split direction, spawn count, and brief warning.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
☐	Carrier Foundry	carrier	spawner	Large mobile spawner; bay animation, child launch, max-child pressure, and foundry death should be unmistakable.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
☐	Combat Summoner	summoner	summoner	Channeling summoner with ranged pressure; summon glyph, spawn burst, and interrupted/death feedback must be readable.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
☐	Spawner Nest	carrier	spawner	Mostly stationary spawn anchor; nest silhouette, spawn cadence, local danger zone, and priority target value must read.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

SUPPORT, COMMAND, AND DEFENSIVE ROLES												
	ENEMY	ROLE	PROTOTYPE REF	DESIGN BRIEF	SIL	MOV	TEL	ATK	AUD	HIT	VAL	
☐	Shield Frigate	shield	shield-bearer	Shield support; aura ownership, protected allies, shield strength, and shield break need clear feedback.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
☐	Repair Skiff	repair	healer	Mobile healer; beam target, healing amount, damaged ally priority, and interruption should be obvious.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
☐	Command Relay	buffer	buffer	Buff support; aura radius, boosted allies, speed/fire-rate state, and relay priority must read in packs.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
☐	Reflector	reflector	reflector	Front-arc reflector; active shield angle, reflection timing, cooldown, and safe shooting window must be legible.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

POSITIONING, STEALTH, PATROL, AND LOOT ROLES												
	ENEMY	ROLE	PROTOTYPE REF	DESIGN BRIEF	SIL	MOV	TEL	ATK	AUD	HIT	VAL	
☐	Scrap Jackal	scavenger	thief	Scrap-seeking runner; pickup intent, flee turn, carried scrap value, and death payout should be clear.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
☐	Scrap Thief	thief	thief	High-speed loot thief; theft moment, escape route, bonus scrap, and chase priority must be readable without UI text.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
☐	Flanker	flanker	flanker	Side-pressure attacker; lateral pathing, attack angle, and commit moment should not look like ordinary chasing.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
☐	Phase Skiff	teleporter	teleporter	Phase mover; departure ring, target arrival ring, invulnerable/unsafe timing, and reentry should be unmistakable.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

	ENEMY	ROLE	PROTOTYPE REF	DESIGN BRIEF	SIL	MOV	TEL	ATK	AUD	HIT	VAL
☐	Ambusher Mine	ambusher	ambusher	Hidden strike mine; reveal range, arming beat, strike lane, and post-reveal chase state must feel fair.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
☐	Orbiter Cage	orbiter	orbiter	Constraining orbiter; orbit radius, tightening pressure, escape gap, and cage ownership should be readable.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
☐	Patrol Guard	patrol	patrol	Territory guard; patrol route, detection state, alert pursuit, and losing aggro should be visible.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

ASTEROID CHECKLIST ITEM

	ASTEROID POLISH SCOPE	SHAPE POOL	TIER SIZE	ASTEROID READ	DENSE FIELD	BREAKUP	IMPACT	LIVE VAL
☐	Random shape from a pooled asteroid-shape set. Size changes by spawn tier. Shape remains asteroid-like, not ship-like or icon-like. Dense-field readability is validated in live gameplay. Breakup, collision, and impact feedback remain clear.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

FINAL VALIDATION CHECKLIST

	VALIDATION STEP	EVIDENCE TO CAPTURE
☐	Run a live gameplay smoke pass with mixed squads, asteroids, pickups, HUD, player shots, and enemy shots active.	Harness output or screenshot path plus notes on any enemy whose role was unclear.
☐	Validate Scout phase timed spawning: no automatic enemy batch at run start, then 1 Scout at 10 seconds, 2 at 20 seconds, 3 at 30 seconds, continuing by elapsed run time.	Focused unit test output and Scout phase harness details showing wave counts from 10 through 60 seconds.
☐	Validate the live enemy cap for Scout phase spawning.	Scout phase harness detail showing active live enemies reaching 500 and staying at or below 500 after another due wave.
☐	Verify automatic enemy systems, directed spawns, squads, world-event guards, rare-event squads, debug spawns, and AI child spawns resolve to Scout during this phase.	Harness or code evidence showing live enemy definition IDs are Scout-only; note any intentionally non-enemy world object, pickup, mission, asteroid, debris, or reward path that remains unchanged.
☐	Capture live performance evidence for the 500-Scout validation mode.	Scout phase harness details, profiler counts or summary, build result, and smoke command output.
☐	Check reduced VFX, reduced flash, high contrast, text scale, and color-safe shots against enemy telegraphs.	Accessibility setting combination and any telegraph that became too faint or too noisy.
☐	Verify attack timing against visual warning timing for charger, sniper, exploder, support, carrier, and status enemies.	Expected warning duration, actual perceived warning duration, and outcome notes.
☐	Verify hit, death, split, summon, shield, repair, reflect, teleport, and loot feedback in dense combat.	Short capture notes for each feedback family, especially failures caused by effect overlap.
☐	Confirm all 26 live enemy display names remain represented if ENEMY_DEFINITIONS changes.	Roster diff or generated name list checked against this document.
☐	Confirm asteroid scope remains one pooled-shape polish item, not separate per-tier checklist rows.	Asteroid implementation note or screenshot proving shape variety and tier sizing in live play.